ADHD EXECUTIVE FUNCTION · TIME ARCHITECTURE

HIGH SIGNAL LLC

The *ADHD Time* Architecture Worksheet

Stop running on neurotypical time math. This worksheet recalibrates your week around how your brain actually works — using evidence-based ADHD time principles, not optimism.

1 Your Commitment Inventory

List every active commitment. Apply the ×2.5 rule. Be honest.

The ×2.5 Rule (Tier 2 EF literature): ADHD time estimates are systematically optimistic. Take your instinctive estimate and multiply by 2.5 — that's your real time cost. A task you think takes 1 hour takes 2.5 hours. A meeting you think takes 30 minutes takes 75 minutes including prep and reorientation.

COMMITMENT / TASK	EST. (HRS)	×2.5 (HRS)	PRIORITY
e.g. Weekly investor update	1h	2.5h	High / Med /

2 The Reality Check

Total your adjusted hours. Compare to actual available hours.

Available Hours / Week

REALISTIC WORKING HOURS

e.g. 35 hrs

MINUS MEETINGS/ADMIN

e.g. –12 hrs

NET AVAILABLE

= 23 hrs

Total Adjusted Hours

SUM OF ALL ×2.5 ESTIMATES

Total hrs

If this exceeds your net available hours, something comes off the list before anything gets added.

Stop/Kill Candidates

WHAT COMES OFF FIRST

These move to your Stop/Kill List — not a parking lot.

3 Your Hyperfocus Conditions

Hyperfocus is a resource, not a liability — when you know how to protect it.

When hyperfocus activates, **do not interrupt it**. Move the next commitment if you can. The interruption cost (15–20 min reorientation) exceeds the value of ending on schedule.

Conditions That Trigger Flow

TIME OF DAY

e.g. 9–11am

ENVIRONMENT

e.g. headphones, no Slack

TASK TYPES

e.g. writing, building

Conditions That Kill Flow

GUARANTEED INTERRUPTIONS

e.g. Slack notifications

ENVIRONMENTS TO AVOID

e.g. open office

TIME PERIODS TO PROTECT

e.g. don't schedule 9–11am

4

Your Non-Negotiable Buffer Rules

Transitions are expensive in ADHD brains. Build them in before you need them.

- [ ] **15 minutes before every meeting** — prep only, no new tasks. Block it on your calendar now.
- [ ] **15 minutes after every meeting** — notes, decisions, next actions. Do not schedule back-to-back.
- [ ] **Between deep work blocks** — minimum 20 minutes before switching task type (creative → analytical, etc.).
- [ ] **End-of-day shutdown ritual** — 15 minutes to close loops, update your list, and set tomorrow's single priority.
- [ ] **My additional rule:**

5 This Week's Non-Negotiables

Three things that ship this week. Everything else is secondary.

NON-NEGOTIABLE #1

SPECIFIC TIME BLOCK

e.g. Tuesday 9–11am

NON-NEGOTIABLE #2

SPECIFIC TIME BLOCK

NON-NEGOTIABLE #3

SPECIFIC TIME BLOCK

> **The dopamine reset rule:** In any deep work block over 90 minutes, include one 10-minute break — movement, music, or low-demand activity. Not optional. Not a reward. A maintenance requirement for the hardware you're running.

High Signal LLC

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Educational resource — not a substitute for therapy, psychiatric care, or clinical evaluation. Evidence references: Barkley (2015) d=0.8 external scaffolding; Martinussen et al. (2005) d=0.7–1.0 WM deficits; Barkley et al. (2001) time perception. Tier designations per High Signal evidence hierarchy.